



# Transferring Data Using Infrared

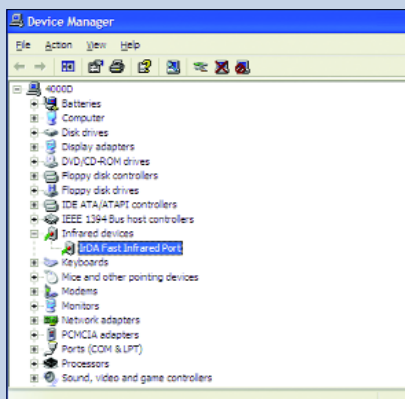
Share data and images wirelessly

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Today, most laptop computers, smartphones and PDAs come equipped with an Infrared (IR) port. Although not as fast or as convenient as Bluetooth data transfer, IR is handy simply on the basis of its widespread availability. Since IR requires line-of-sight to work, you need to be careful to align the IR ports on the two devices you wish to use and ensure that neither of them is moved while data transfer is in progress.

Here, we look at the steps involved in transferring data using a laptop with Windows XP to another IR capable device such as a mobile phone.

**STEP 1** Make sure the drivers for the IR port in the laptop are installed. To do this, go to Start > Settings > Control Panel > System. Click on the 'Hardware' tab and choose 'Device Manager'. Next, click the '+' sign next to 'Infrared Devices'. The IR device in the laptop will be listed here. Double-click on the device name to display properties. The window that pops up next will show the device status. You



The 'Device Manager' shows the status of installed components

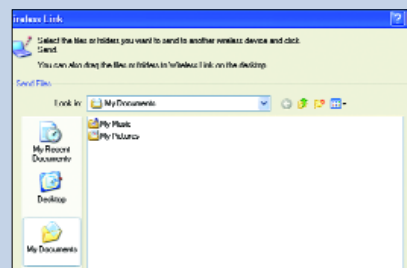
will need to install the correct drivers from the CD that came along with your laptop or procure them from your laptop vendor in case the drivers are not installed.

**STEP 2** To transfer data such as images from the laptop to a mobile phone, enable

Infrared in the phone. The procedure for this will differ according to phone manufacturer, but the menu listing to do this is usually available in 'Settings' or 'Connectivity' options in the phone menu. Refer user manual for help.

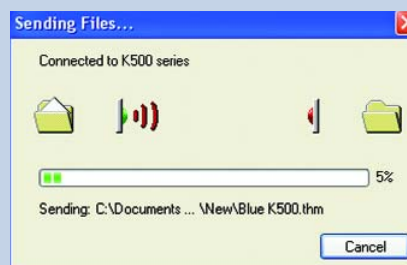
**STEP 3** Place the laptop on a stable surface such as a table and align the IR port on the mobile phone with that on the laptop. The laptop will detect the new device automatically. A new icon called 'Send files to another computer' appears within the system tray.

**STEP 4** Double-click on the icon. A browse window pops up. Browse to the location where the files to be transferred are located and select them for transfer.



Selecting files to transfer

**STEP 5** Click on Send. The recipient device will ask for a confirmation on whether you want to accept the transfer or not. Select [Yes] to continue. The



Infrared transfer in progress

transfer will start and a progress window will now display the status.

**To send data from the mobile phone to the laptop, follow these steps.**

**STEP 1** Activate IR in the phone as in Step 2, above.

**STEP 2** Navigate to the appropriate location in the phone where the file to be transferred is stored. If the phone has a file manager, this would be the most convenient way to do it. In case there is no file manager in the phone, the file will be stored in an appropriate location such as 'Image Gallery' for images or 'Recorder' for audio files and so on.

**STEP 3** Press 'Options' or 'More' and then select the 'Send' option that will appear.

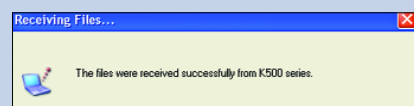
**STEP 4** Select Infrared as the mode of transfer and align the IR port on the phone with that on the laptop.

**STEP 5** A window will appear on the laptop screen asking you to accept the transfer. Click on Yes to continue.



Transfer confirmation window

**STEP 6** After the transfer is complete, another window informs you that the files were received successfully. It's a swap!



File transfer successfully completed